

THE MISSING POPULATION

Exploring the Role of Psychedelic Assisted Therapy (PAT) in Facilitating Post Traumatic Growth among Domestic Violence and Sexual Abuse (DVSA) Survivors

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GAP ONE: WHO IS STUDIED

DVSA survivors are **almost absent** or **hidden** in mixed PTSD samples.



GAP TWO: WHAT IS MEASURED

Therapy is called transformative, but measured mainly with **symptom scales**; **growth** is barely measured.

WHY THE GAPS CONNECT

A different kind of wound
Freyd, 1996 – betrayal trauma.

THE MODEL TRIALS WERE BUILT ON



PTSD, combat, single-incident trauma, fear conditioning.

WHAT THIS POPULATION CARRIES



Relational trauma, betrayal, shame, self-blame, disrupted identity; not fear alone.

AIM

To explore whether and how psychedelic-assisted therapy may support post-traumatic growth in adult survivors of domestic violence and sexual abuse, and what meaningful change means to survivors and practitioners.

POST-TRAUMATIC GROWTH (PTG)

Tedeschi & Calhoun

Positive psychological change that can emerge through the struggle with trauma and can sit right alongside ongoing pain.



RELATIONSHIPS

Stronger connections and deeper empathy with others.



NEW POSSIBILITIES

Openness to new opportunities, paths, and life choices.



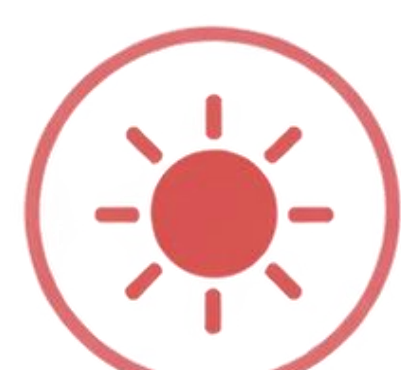
PERSONAL STRENGTH

Greater sense of inner strength, resilience, and self-reliance.



EXISTENTIAL CHANGE

Deeper understanding of life, purpose, and spiritual perspective.



APPRECIATION OF LIFE

Stronger gratitude and greater appreciation for each day.

PTG is NOT ✗ resilience ✗ symptom relief ✗ absence of distress

METHODS



1 REVIEW

Scoping review
Evidence on PTG after trauma



2 SURVIVORS

Survivor study
Interviews + PTGI



3 PRACTITIONERS

Practitioner study
Therapist interviews



4 INTEGRATION

Bringing findings together

No mixed-methods study has examined post-traumatic growth in DVSA survivors receiving psychedelic-assisted therapy. That gap is what this PhD is built to answer.

PROJECT DESIGN



Nested in trials

clinical context retained



Lived experience leads

survivor accounts are central



Scores as a second lens

quantitative measures support but do not replace participant accounts



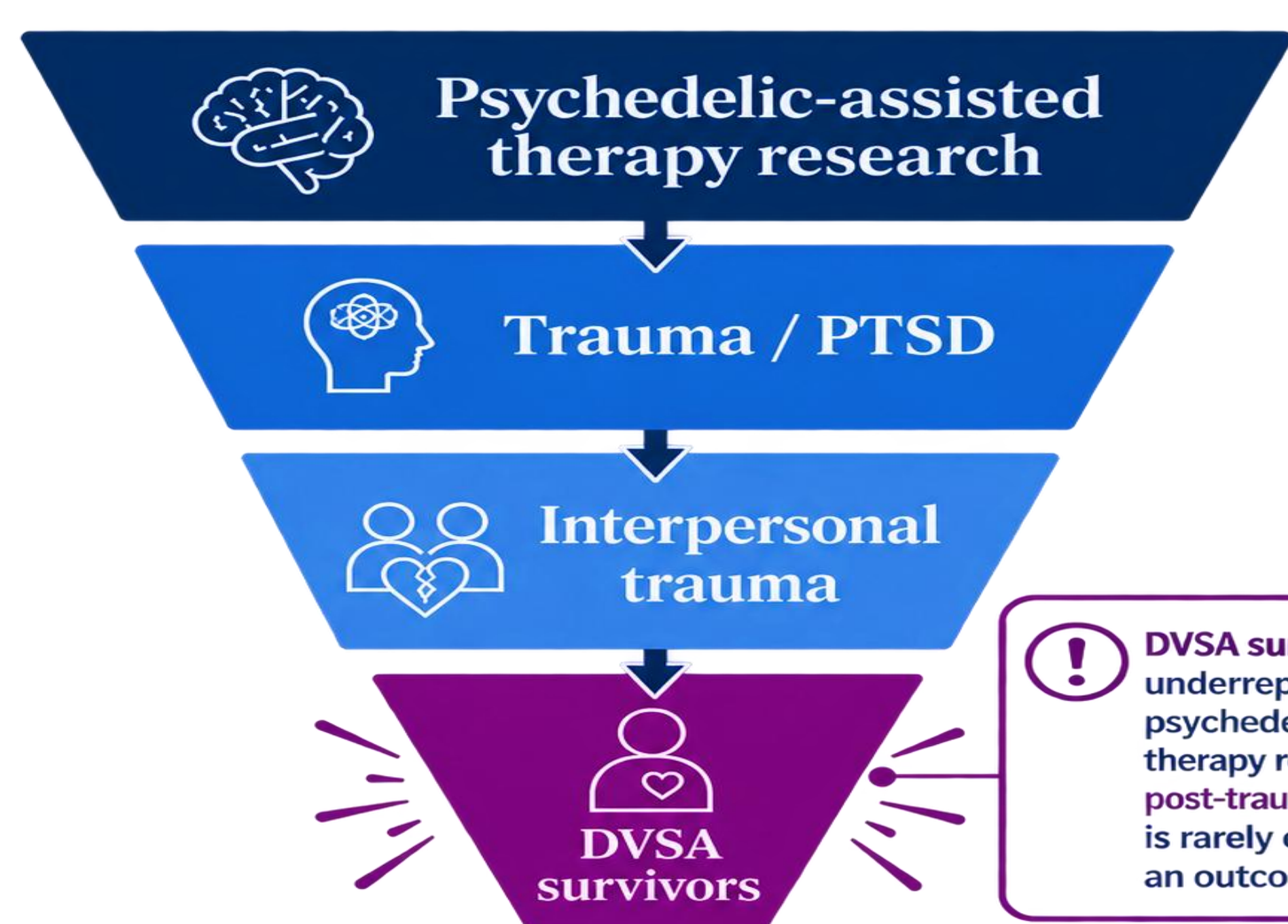
Integrated per person

individual experiences remain visible

A qualitative-led, mixed-methods design, nested in active trials.

WHY PSYCHEDELIC-ASSISTED THERAPY AND THE GAP

Psychedelic-assisted therapy shows growing promise for PTSD. But DVSA survivors are rarely studied on their own terms, and growth is rarely measured.



! DVSA survivors are underrepresented in psychedelic-assisted therapy research, and post-traumatic growth is rarely examined as an outcome.



This PhD asks about identity, relationships, agency, meaning and the possibility of growth.

WHY IT MATTERS

If psychedelic-assisted therapy is to **transform** trauma care, it must ask more than *whether symptoms reduce*. It must also ask **what recovery means** to survivors — and **who is being left out**.

PTG may offer one framework for meaningful change, if used critically and survivor-centredly.

